

Leila Hallenberg

Senior Game Designer — Systems, Economy & Live-Service

Game Designer, Problem Solver. Systems-focused game designer crafting economies, progression loops, and engagement systems.

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SUMMARY

Senior Game Designer specializing in **systems**, **economy** and **progression** for live-service products.

I combine mathematics, player psychology, and hands-on implementation to build engaging, scalable meta-game structures. Experienced designing long-term engagement loops that drive retention, motivation, and meaningful player choice.

EXPERIENCE

Modoyo — Senior Game Designer (Systems, Economy & Live-ops), Heart Electric

2022 - PRESENT | Stockholm

At Modoyo, I was hired to design and own the implementation of the meta-game aspects and live service of the online hero shooter Heart Electric.

RESPONSIBILITIES

- Core Systems & Economy:
 - Designed, balanced, and implemented all major progression systems: leveling & XP models, soft/hard currency flows, reward cadence, and long-term engagement curves.
 - Built progression & unlock systems (heroes, weapons, mods, perks, cosmetics) supporting both early acquisition hooks and long-term mastery paths.
- Live-Ops & Seasonal:
 - Designed the live-ops roadmap and seasonal engagement frameworks, including seasonal shop, ranked seasons, and retention-oriented reward pacing.
 - Modeled economy inflation, content cadence, and player investment over time.
- Social & Competitive Systems:
 - Designed player-facing social features including clans, player profiles, achievements, and personalization.
 - Delivered documented designs and balancing models for Ranked Leagues and MMR.
- Technical Implementation:
 - Implemented features in UE5 in close collaboration with engineers.
 - Drove features from concept → specification → implementation → iteration, coordinating with cross-disciplinary teams of 5–10 people.
 - Analyzed metrics, surveys, and churn indicators to inform iteration.

CORE SKILLS

- Systems Design
- Economy Design
- Progression/Engagement
- Live-Ops Design
- Player Psychology
- Data-informed Workflow
- Cross-Disciplinary Collaboration
- Documentation & Specs
- Rapid Prototyping

TOOLS

- Spreadsheet modelling
- UE5 (Blueprints & C++)
- Unity
- C# / Python
- SQL (Snowflake)

LANGUAGES

- Swedish (native)
- English (fluent)

HIGHLIGHTS

- **Practice Range** – Onboarding feature
 - Identified churn pain points of playtesting and onboarding
 - Collaborated with designers + engineers to ship under tight timeline
 - Projected to reduce initial churn by 30%
 - **Loadout Builder** – Engagement feature
 - Designed & implemented the Loadout Builder system, creating a strong early power progression hook (~30h) and deep long-term collection/mastery motivations (300h+).
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Sumo Digital — *Senior Game Designer, Stampede Racing Royale*

2021 - 2022 | Leamington Spa (Remote)

Worked on early gameplay and meta-progression development for Stampede Racing Royale, shaping core modes, content cadence, and player progression in collaboration with a multidisciplinary team.

RESPONSIBILITIES

- Designed the player progression roadmap, reward distribution structures, and long-term content cadence for the live-ops model.
- Designed and implemented gameplay modes through rapid Unity prototyping.
- Authored documentation for gameplay features, systems, and iteration flows.

HIGHLIGHTS

- **Elimination Race** – Core Game Mode
 - Designed and implemented a full PvP/PvE hybrid race mode including controls, pacing, elimination mechanics, and reward structures based on placement and performance.
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Star Stable Entertainment — *Game Designer, Star Stable Online*

2016 - 2021 | Stockholm

Began as a content designer and grew into systemic and engagement-focused design across major features for the live MMORPG Star Stable Online.

HIGHLIGHTS

- **Soul Riding** – Engagement Feature
 - Analyzed player activity data to determine reactivation opportunities.
 - Designed the feature and led cross-disciplinary implementation.
 - Result: Reactivation of 5% of churned players, 20% daily playtime increase among all players after launch.
- **Live-Ops Features**
 - **Global Store** – Economy Feature designed to be accessible from anywhere in the game to improve player spending and act as a currency sink.
 - **Halloween & Winter** – Limited Time Events using modular and recycled assets. Built reward structures appealing to both casual and high-engagement players leading to increased player activity and revenue during peak annual windows.
- **Scalable Content Systems**
 - **Collections** – Designed a modular system enabling large content drops at minimal development cost.

- **Trail Rides** – Designed a systemic framework allowing players to craft their own exploratory stories.

EDUCATION

Playground Squad — *Game Design Curriculum*

2015 - 2017 | Falun

Vocational degree with training in game design, C++, agile development, and three game projects. Completed a 6-month internship at Star Stable Entertainment.

REFERENCES AVAILABLE UPON REQUEST